

Troubleshooting Methodology -- Guided Notes

Unit tp-1.8 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 1.4 | N10-008 FC0-U71 1.4

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Complete each question using the lesson reading. Write in the blank or answer in the space provided.

Question 1

The CompTIA troubleshooting methodology has _____ steps. Step 1 is _____. Step 2 is _____. Step 3 is _____. Skipping steps -- especially jumping from Step 1 directly to implementing a fix -- often results in _____ the wrong problem.

Question 2

In Step 1 (identify the problem), a technician should ask _____ -ended questions (e.g., 'What happens when you turn it on?') rather than _____ questions (e.g., 'Does it turn on?'). Open questions gather _____ detail and lead to better theories in Step 2.

Question 3

Step 4 is to establish a/an _____ of action to resolve the problem, including identifying potential _____ of the planned fix. This prevents a technician from solving one problem while creating another. Step 5 is to _____ the solution and then _____ full system functionality.

Question 4

Step 6 is to _____ findings, actions, and outcomes. This creates a reference for future similar issues and protects the technician legally if decisions are later questioned. Step 7 is to _____ the user -- explaining what caused the problem and how to prevent it in plain language.

Question 5

The distinction between a _____ (what the user reports, e.g., 'the screen is black') and a _____ (the actual technical cause, e.g., 'the GPU is unseated') is critical. Fixing a symptom without identifying the _____ will result in the problem _____.

Question 6

When testing a theory in Step 3 and the theory is _____, the technician should either establish a new theory or _____ to a higher skill level. Before escalating, the technician should document _____ steps already tried so the next technician does not repeat them.

Question 7

When questioning a user in Step 1, a technician should ask whether any _____ were made recently -- such as software updates, new hardware, or changed settings. These changes are often the _____ of sudden failures. The technician should also reproduce the problem if possible to _____.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A technician skips steps and immediately reinstalls the OS on a laptop with a reported display problem, which takes 3 hours and does not fix the issue. The actual cause was a loose display cable. Identify which troubleshooting steps were skipped, explain what the correct process would have been, and describe the cost of skipping the methodology.

Download the answer key from the class server:

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wget http://[SERVER]/resources/network-engineer/tp-1-8-troubleshooting-methodology/tp-1-8-troubleshooting-methodology-answer-key.pdf
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